

035 Lay an insect pitfall trap

15
MINS

While humans sleep, many insects are on the move—flying through the night air or crawling over soil. Make a pitfall trap and catch some of these nocturnal creepy-crawlies. Just be sure to let them go again.

What you need

- Trowel • Yogurt cup
- Bait (cheese, fruit, meat) • 4 stones
- Tile or piece of wood 4 in (10 cm) square



1 Dig a hole in soft ground and bury the cup so that its rim is level with the soil. Pack soil around the cup's edges. Add some bait.

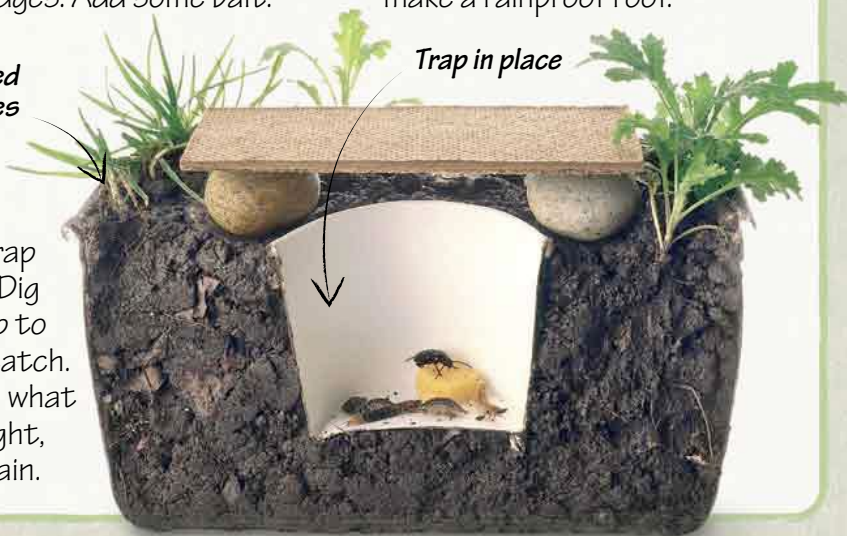


2 Put the stones on the ground around the trap and place the tile on top to make a rainproof roof.

Soil packed around edges

Trap in place

3 Leave the trap overnight. Dig up the trap to view your catch. Note down what you've caught, and try again.



036 Lift logs to find insects

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Lift a log to see underneath. Ants, beetles, woodlice, and centipedes may be living there. Put the log back safely.

